

Make Winning an Attitude: Practice Your Belief, Featuring Timothy Alexander

Timothy Alexander, Director of UAB Football Character Excellence Program & Life Coach

As Pat said, “Belief is actually a fairly practical matter. Most people think of it as something mystical, or at least highly conceptual. I don’t. To me, the strongest kind of belief is grounded in reality. Like anything else, it’s largely a result of focus, hard work, and other verifiable things.”

I’m Timothy Alexander. I was on my way to a Division I college football career until a car accident left me paralyzed from the neck down. The doctor told me I had a 5% chance of ever being able to walk, talk, or do anything on my own. I thought to myself, “If I believe what the doctor is saying, then my story ends right here. But if I keep on pushing, then my story begins right here.”

When adversity comes, how do you respond? Every comeback starts with belief. You have to remember everything you’ve practiced up to the present and believe it’s enough to carry you forward. Winning is a habit that starts with your mind. Pat Summitt coached 12 seasons and went to the Final Four seven times before winning her first national title in 1987. Pat’s mental focus helped her hold the course and find success.

Here are three ways to practice believing in yourself when you encounter adversity.

Number one, make it personal. When life hands you a loss, don’t let it be the end of your story. Make it the beginning. Begin with saying, “Yes, I can.” And then live that belief out day by day.

Number two, see every setback as an opportunity to learn. With this perspective, the weakest moments of your life are positioned to become the strongest parts of your testimony. You have to take everything you’ve learned and apply it in adversity. Belief is not just for the sunshine. It’s for the rain. When you make failure your teacher, you learn to never give up, even through the storms.

Number three, let your attitude drive what you do. What you believe about yourself in any situation will inform how you apply yourself to that situation. So, believe you can win. Then, form your work ethic around that core belief.

Don’t give up when something goes wrong. Don’t just sit back when the excitement fades. Continue moving forward. If you think you can, you will. If you think you can’t, you won’t.

Are you ready to practice your positivity? Start with believing in yourself today. Win with your mind and train yourself to expect the extraordinary.